

D741

Student Teaching I in Secondary Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A candidate teaching ninth-grade biology notices that one student works carefully when alone but takes silly risks with lab equipment when his friends are at the same table. The lab room was renovated last summer and has new fume hoods. Which explanation and response fit adolescent development best?

- A. He lacks lab knowledge, so reteach safety rules.
- B. The new equipment is distracting him, so return to older materials.
- C. Peer presence heightens reward sensitivity, so assign structured lab roles and seat him where status comes from doing the role well.
- D. Teens never make safe choices with friends, so ban group labs.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants to use adolescents' peer sensitivity to improve homework completion. Which approach uses it well?

- A. Assign all homework as individual work only.
- B. Raise the point value of homework.
- C. Post a ranked list of each student's missing assignments.
- D. Set up small study teams that earn shared recognition when all members improve.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

An eleventh grader who used to write about wanting to be a veterinarian now says she might be a musician or a lawyer, and she recently joined debate. Her attendance is excellent and she takes the bus 25 minutes each way. The candidate is planning a career-connected writing task. Which approach fits identity development?

- A. Refer her to the counselor for lack of focus.
- B. Let students research and compare two possible paths and reflect on which values each one fits.
- C. Ask her to pick one career now and stick with it for the whole unit.
- D. Assign a task about school transportation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A candidate has an observation next Tuesday during a period that starts right after lunch. She has noticed that the same six students answer most questions. The supervisor drives in from another city for each visit. What should the candidate do before the observation?

- A. Wait for the supervisor to decide what matters.
- B. Ask the supervisor to give general comments on the whole lesson.
- C. Move the lesson to a morning period.
- D. Ask the supervisor to track which students respond and how questions are distributed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

During a group project in a tenth-grade history class, a student scribbles on a shared poster made by his group. The class meets in a portable building near the track, and the project is worth 15% of the grade. Which consequence is logical?

- A. He receives a zero on the whole project.
- B. He helps the group redo the damaged section during work time.
- C. He writes the class rules fifty times.
- D. He loses five minutes of lunch.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A student who transferred mid-year finally solves a hard chemistry problem after trying three methods. The class has 34 students and the room has no windows. Which response is process praise?

- A. "You're a natural at chemistry."
- B. "You kept switching strategies until one worked. That persistence is what cracked it."
- C. "Great, that was the easiest one on the page."
- D. "Good job."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student fails a quiz after studying the night before by rereading notes. Which teacher response applies process-focused feedback to a failure?

- A.** “Rereading didn’t stick. Let’s try self-quizzing over three days and see if it helps.”
- B.** “Don’t worry, not everyone is a math person.”
- C.** “At least you tried hard.”
- D.** “You’ll always do better next time.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

In a hybrid English course, the candidate posts ‘What did you think of chapter 4?’ and gets replies like ‘It was good.’ The course uses a new learning platform the district bought this year, and most students post from phones. Which revision is most likely to deepen discussion?

- A.** “Is the narrator reliable? Take a side, quote one line, and reply to a classmate who disagrees.”
- B.** Switch to a platform with a better phone app.
- C.** Drop online discussions, since they never work.
- D.** “Write at least 300 words about chapter 4.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An online prompt asks students to take a position, cite a source, and reply to a peer, yet replies still say only ‘I agree.’ What is the most likely missing piece?

- A.** Clear reply norms with a model, such as ‘add evidence or ask a question.’
- B.** A longer initial post requirement.
- C.** Removing the reply requirement.
- D.** A new position prompt.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A candidate plans a U.S. history unit on westward expansion. All six sources come from settlers' diaries and government reports. The mentor teacher likes projects that use poster board, and the unit lasts three weeks. Which change best adds multiple perspectives?

- A. Have students make posters of settlers' routes.
- B. Add a one-day 'diversity' activity at the end of the unit.
- C. Add primary sources from Native nations and Mexican residents of the region and have students compare accounts.
- D. Remove the settlers' diaries entirely.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A unit already includes sources from several groups. Which sign shows the perspectives are still being treated as add-ons?

- A. The sources vary in length.
- B. Students compare two accounts in a graded task.
- C. The final essay asks students to use only the textbook account.
- D. Some sources are primary and some secondary.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A candidate starts a placement with five sections of ninth-grade math in a school that recently switched to block scheduling. She has 140 students and the school uses an online grade portal. What should she do in the first two weeks to build family partnerships?

- A. Wait to contact families until grades post in the portal.
- B. Contact only families of students who are already struggling.
- C. Send a list of classroom rules and penalties home.
- D. Send each family a short positive note or call that introduces her and invites them to share about their student.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A candidate teaching ninth-grade biology notices that one student works carefully when alone but takes silly risks with lab equipment when his friends are at the same table. ~~The lab room was renovated last summer and has new fume hoods.~~ Which explanation and response fit adolescent development best?

Target word: developmental explanation and plan **Decides:** Risky behavior rises with peers watching.

A	Adjacent category	He works safely alone, so knowledge is not the problem.
B	Camouflage	Uses the renovation detail; the pattern depends on peers, not equipment.
C	Correct	Teens take more risks around peers; structure and roles channel that social reward.
D	Absolute language	Overstates the pattern and removes valuable peer learning.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A teacher wants to use adolescents' peer sensitivity to improve homework completion. Which approach uses it well?

Target word: reverse: harness rather than explain **Decides:** Positive peer status for productive behavior.

A	Dropped element	Removes the peer factor instead of using it.
B	Confusion set	A grade lever, not a peer lever.
C	Inverted operation	Uses peers to shame, which can raise avoidance and harm relationships.
D	Correct	Peer reward is linked to the target behavior.

3. Answer B Concept 2

An eleventh grader who used to write about wanting to be a veterinarian now says she might be a musician or a lawyer, and she recently joined debate. ~~Her attendance is excellent and she takes the bus 25 minutes each way.~~ The candidate is planning a career-connected writing task. Which approach fits identity development?

Target word: support identity exploration **Decides:** Changing goals signals normal role exploration.

A	Adjacent category	Treats a normal stage as a problem needing referral.
B	Correct	Exploration of roles and values supports healthy identity formation.
C	Inverted operation	Forces early closure when exploration is the developmental task.
D	Camouflage	Uses the bus detail; it does not address identity.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A candidate has an observation next Tuesday ~~during a period that starts right after lunch.~~ She has noticed that the same six students answer most questions. ~~The supervisor drives in from another city for each visit.~~ What should the candidate do before the observation?

Target word: set up useful feedback **Decides:** Name one focus and the evidence to collect.

A	Inverted operation	Reverses ownership; the candidate should direct the feedback she needs.
B	Dropped element	Drops the focus; general comments rarely change practice.
C	Camouflage	Uses the after-lunch detail; timing is not the concern she has noticed.
D	Correct	A specific focus and data request produce feedback she can act on.

5. Answer B Concept 4

During a group project in a tenth-grade history class, a student scribbles on a shared poster made by his group. ~~The class meets in a portable building near the track, and the project is worth 15% of the grade.~~ Which consequence is logical?

Target word: choose a logical consequence **Decides:** Related, respectful, reasonable, and repairing.

A	Camouflage	Uses the grade weight; it is not reasonable or repairing.
B	Correct	Repairs the harm and is directly related to the behavior.
C	Confusion set	Busywork punishment, not a related consequence.
D	Adjacent category	A punishment unrelated to the harm done.

6. Answer B Concept 5

A student who transferred mid-year finally solves a hard chemistry problem after trying three methods. ~~The class has 34 students and the room has no windows.~~ Which response is process praise?

Target word: wording of praise **Decides:** Praise the strategy and effort.

A	Inverted operation	Praises a fixed trait, the opposite of process praise.
B	Correct	Names the controllable process that led to success.
C	Confusion set	Undercuts effort and signals the task was trivial.
D	Dropped element	Drops the specific process; students cannot tell what to repeat.

7. Answer A Concept 5 · transfer

A student fails a quiz after studying the night before by rereading notes. Which teacher response applies process-focused feedback to a failure?

Target word: reverse: struggle rather than success **Decides:** Point to a changeable strategy.

A	Correct	Links the result to a strategy the student can change.
B	Inverted operation	Attributes the result to a fixed trait.
C	Dropped element	Praises effort but drops the strategy change needed.
D	Absolute language	Empty promise with no process to change.

8. Answer A Concept 6

In a hybrid English course, the candidate posts 'What did you think of chapter 4?' and gets replies like 'It was good.' ~~The course uses a new learning platform the district bought this year, and most students post from phones.~~ Which revision is most likely to deepen discussion?

Target word: prompt design **Decides:** Require a claim, evidence, and peer response.

A	Correct	A position, evidence, and required interaction produce depth.
B	Camouflage	Uses the platform detail; the prompt, not the tool, is the issue.
C	Absolute language	Overgeneralizes from a weak prompt.
D	Confusion set	Length does not create thinking or interaction.

9. Answer A Concept 6 · transfer

An online prompt asks students to take a position, cite a source, and reply to a peer, yet replies still say only ‘I agree.’ What is the most likely missing piece?

Target word: reverse: diagnose from weak replies **Decides:** Reply norms and models were not set.

A	Correct	Students need a norm and example for what a substantive reply looks like.
B	Adjacent category	Targets posts, not the weak replies.
C	Dropped element	Drops interaction rather than improving it.
D	Inverted operation	The prompt already asks for a position; the gap is at the reply step.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A candidate plans a U.S. history unit on westward expansion. All six sources come from settlers’ diaries and government reports. ~~The mentor teacher likes projects that use poster board, and the unit lasts three weeks.~~ Which change best adds multiple perspectives?

Target word: counter-narrative in sources **Decides:** Sources all come from one viewpoint.

A	Camouflage	Uses the poster preference; adds no new perspective.
B	Adjacent category	Tacks on a side lesson while the main narrative stays one-sided.
C	Correct	Brings in voices of groups directly affected and uses them in the main analysis.
D	Inverted operation	Replaces one single view with another; the goal is comparison.

11. Answer C Concept 7 · transfer

A unit already includes sources from several groups. Which sign shows the perspectives are still being treated as add-ons?

Target word: reverse: detect tokenism **Decides:** Other sources are not used in assessed analysis.

A	Confusion set	Length does not decide whether they are central.
B	Inverted operation	That is real integration.
C	Correct	If other voices never count in the main task, they are decorations.
D	Adjacent category	Source type is a separate question from perspective.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A candidate starts a placement with five sections of ninth-grade math ~~in a school that recently switched to block scheduling.~~ She has 140 students ~~and the school uses an online grade portal.~~ What should she do in the first two weeks to build family partnerships?

Target word: first family contact **Decides:** Early positive two-way contact before problems.

A	Camouflage	Uses the portal; relies on grades instead of relationship.
B	Dropped element	Drops the positive, whole-group contact that makes later calls easier.
C	Confusion set	One-way and rule-focused, not a partnership.
D	Correct	An early positive, two-way contact builds trust before concerns arise.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Adolescent reward sensitivity and peer context	Teen brains are highly sensitive to rewards and peer presence, so structured peer work and public status cues strongly shape behavior and risk-taking.	Assuming teens decide the same way alone as with friends watching.	A behavior changes when classmates are watching.
2	Identity development in adolescence	Adolescents are working out who they are (identity vs. role confusion), so tasks that let them explore roles, values, and choices support learning.	Reading shifting interests and trying on roles as a lack of focus to be corrected.	A student keeps changing groups, styles, or stated goals.
3	Requesting focused feedback	Before an observation, name one specific area and the evidence you want collected, so feedback is usable.	Asking the observer to 'tell me anything' and getting vague praise.	"What should the candidate do before the next observation?"
4	Logical consequences	A logical consequence is related to the behavior, respectful, and reasonable, and it helps the student repair or relearn.	Choosing any consequence the student dislikes, even if it is unrelated.	The question asks for a consequence that 'fits' a behavior.
5	Process praise	Praise effort, strategy, and improvement rather than fixed traits, so students link success to things they can control.	Telling students they are 'so smart' or 'a natural.'	The teacher is choosing words to respond to a success or a struggle.
6	Designing online discussion prompts	Strong online prompts require a position, evidence, and a response to a peer, with clear norms and a deadline structure.	Posting 'What did you think of the reading?' and expecting depth.	Online replies are short, repetitive, and never reference each other.
7	Multiple perspectives and counter-narratives	Culturally relevant units include voices and sources from the groups involved, not only the dominant account.	Adding a single 'diversity' day while the main narrative stays one-sided.	A unit's sources all come from one viewpoint.
8	Positive first contact with families	Make an early, positive, two-way contact with each family before any problem arises, so later concerns land on trust.	Contacting families only when there is a problem.	"What should the teacher do at the start of the placement?"

Course scope (public description): Student Teaching I is the first part of a two-part series and is a mandatory course for all candidates seeking initial licensure. This course provides a supervised classroom experience in a real-world setting, allowing candidates to demonstrate and reflect upon professional ethics and dispositions, collaborate with experienced teachers, and implement instructional strategies rooted in students' learning and developmental patterns. Building on the responsibilities and skills developed in Advanced Clinical, candidates will receive ongoing feedback through observations and evaluations. Feedback will encourage candidates to reflect on their commitment to professional practices as educators, analyze and adjust teaching methods, and explore new teaching materials and methods that are culturally relevant. Additionally, the course features synchronous learning sessions that delve into communication and collaboration, accepting feedback, creating positive learning environments, and technology and online learning. Candidates must attend the required synchronous learning sessions in addition to their classroom placement.